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Empire School Council Agenda
January 14, 2025 at 6:30 PM

meet.google.com/guu-gwde-zxk

Welcome and Round table Introductions (Khaled + attendees - 10 min)

Approval of previous month meeting minutes

Principal / Vice-principal Report (Lynda/Lindsay - 10 min)

- EQAO: Date is not yet picked, this usually occurs toward the end of May, or beginning of June. The test is online. Dates will be posted on School Day when they are available.
- Crazy carpets are now available during class time.
- Dental screening starts soon for JK, SK, Grade 2. Parents were notified via School Day. For parents wishing to opt out of this screening, there is a form on School Day to fill out and submit. Parents may request this screening for Grade 3 and up.
- Vision screening will begin in Mar for SK's.

Update on the PRO Grant / UWaterloo"QUEST" STEM night update (Khaled - 10 min)

- Last year we had a STEM night hosted by UofW Engineering dept. They come to the school, bring equipment to explain different science and math topics.
- We will be applying for the PRO Grant to apply toward STEM night. Program came from the board last week - time to apply is short - the deadline is Jan 27th.
- We will be using the same vendors and activities, and we have last year's draft so we will be basing the application on this. The grant proposal will be sent out to be reviewed by the council next week.
- We haven't yet heard from UofW to schedule the date - we should be hearing from them shortly and are planning to ask if the activities will be the same or updated for this year.
- Part of the ProGrant requirement is submitting a form after the event with feedback. Last year's feedback is available.

Arts Night (Lynda/Lindsay - 10 min)

- Our staff is planning to have a talent show in June, similar to last year. Students can audition and share their talents. It can be any talent: acting, singing, dancing, jokes etc. The goal is to be inclusive, and we encourage everyone to try out. More details to come.

Empire Soccer Goals Project (Khaled - 10 min)

- This is an investment project. Approval will be contingent to funding. Currently we have no net, only one post and soccer is quite popular at Empire. We'd like them to have 2 nets and be able to play properly and safely.
- Our goal posts are currently owned by the city. We have spoken to a vendor but progress was halted toward the end of last school year.
- Different sizes are available, the middle size will work well for both our younger and older students. The price range is in the thousand's ~ $5000. We do have some funding but will require more to cover this.
- We have reached out to the vendor again for an updated quote - the price remains the same however the transportation expense to deliver from Toronto has increased from last year.
- Prior to purchasing Facilities needs to approve the placement etc. Lynda will follow up to request the approval. A requirement is that the vendor is city and board-approved. Also a board-approved installer will need to be selected.
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Brainstorm ideas for fundraising and events (All Council)

- We discussed new ideas for funding the soccer goals project
- Flipgive: you can buy gift cards from them and then a percentage goes back to the school.
- Khaled spoke to Pizzaville and was given a phone number for management to discuss sponsorship programs.
- STEM night and the talent show will both be good opportunities for fundraising and adding members to the council.
- In the past, an envelope to give money rather than participating in fundraising was well-received and simple.
- Donations through WEFI (Waterloo Educational Fund Investment) account. WEFI is the only board-approved way to receive cash donations. Fundraising categories can be set up - Empire will have an account within the group. There's a link to it from the School Board website and Empire website emp.wrdsb.ca/wefi/
- Lunch options: Lynda has a PitaPit connection. Ordering is simple, 5% roughly is given back to the school. It's usually around $4, and there is planning to ensure it is accessible for our students. Lynda will reach out to her contact, planning potentially for Thursdays starting in Feb. Price range: $4-5.00.

Kindergarten Registration

- We have received feedback that the registration process is not user friendly as compared to other boards. This year registration opened earlier than usual, however content updates had not yet been completed. There are currently some details from last year that still require updating. Lynda will get in touch with them with this feedback.

Adjournment

Next Meeting: Tuesday, February 11, 2025 at 6:30 PM at the Library or online.